

DigiPick of the month

Airwaves Afloat!



Last month's winner:

Utkarsh Arora

Gurgaon

Participate and win next month:

**Professional
XNA Game Programming**

by Benjamin Nitschke



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WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier.

E-mail your picture with **"DigiPick"** in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

RETIRED HURT

Wii Causes "Wiiitis"

Sales notwithstanding, there have been quite a few reports about how Nintendo's Wii has been the cause of a number of untoward incidents. First there were the straps that got broken all the time, causing you to insure everything in the house (including yourself). Then came the candle-stick hack that tickled our ribs, and now it's got its own medical condition—"Wiiitis."

For once, Nintendo is well out of the controversy. Dr Julio Bonis of Boston in the US woke up one fine morning to a very sore shoulder. What surprised the doc was that he had done absolutely nothing physical in the days prior to the injury, and had been a complete couch potato. That's when he remembered his new Wii. Bonis, it turns out, had been playing Wii Tennis for hours on his darling console. When he diagnosed his problem, he

decided it wasn't tennis elbow he was dealing with.

The doctor dashed off a letter to the New England Journal of Medicine explaining the injury and its symptoms, and suggesting a remedy for the case: "The treatment consisted of ibuprofen for one week, as well as complete abstinence from playing Wii video games. The patient recovered fully." He also suggested the injury be labelled more specifically as "Wiiitis."

Well done, Dr Bonis, you warm the cockles of our shoulder... err... hearts.

ROYAL MAIL

Spam Queen

We all have relatives who couldn't care a damn about computers. Some amongst us also have relatives who discovered computers and the Internet, like them, and now seem addicted! Imagine how irritating it can be when your uncle or aunt starts sending you forwards you read two years ago! We look upon with pity at the plight

of Princes Henry and William when we discovered that the Queen, aged 81 when this was written, has taken to the Internet with full gusto, and regularly bombards the inboxes of the young princes along with the rest of her immediate family.

In true blue-blooded fashion, the Queen dictates her e-mails instead of writing them. Having said that, the monarch is pretty tech-savvy: she owns a mobile phone and an iPod. Just last year she made her annual Christmas Day message available for the first time as a podcast. We just hope, for the princes' sake, that she lightens up on those forwards...

An aside: it's "Queen's English," meaning her own. So does she use spell check?

I SEE LITTLE PEOPLE

Lilliputians On Vista DVDs

A Spanish blogger, Kwisatz, was supposedly the first to spot a photograph of

People Who Changed Computing

The C Evangelists



Ritchie



Kernighan

Brian Kernighan and Dennis Ritchie wrote *The C Programming Language* in 1986. The version described in that book became a sort of standard, and was even named "K&R C". Developed in 1972, C is the most widely-used language in application and OS development even today.

Ritchie, a researcher in the Software and Computer Science Laboratory at Bell Labs, once wanted to be a physicist, but his undergraduate experience convinced him otherwise. Following in his father's footsteps—he'd written a significant book on switching circuits—Ritchie joined Bell Labs. Soon after, he wrote a compiler for ALTRAN, a language and system for symbolic calculation, and a key program in the creation of UNIX. Subsequently, he helped Ken Thompson with UNIX. He then added data types and new syntax to Thompson's B language, which evolved into C.

Kernighan studied engineering physics as an undergraduate. With his first computer, the IBM 650, he learnt a bit of FORTRAN, which got him hooked to programming: we've read that he was a terrible programmer! His thesis was titled *Programming in artificial intelligence*, and he went on to attend graduate school. After that, Kernighan worked at Bell Labs with Thompson and Ritchie, and contributed significantly to UNIX, which is written in C. In 1983, Ritchie was awarded the Turing Award for generic OS theory.